> from Nazi methods. The paradox is glaringly obvious when one remembers, first, the Arab sympathies for the Nazi cause during the Second World War and then the support—seldom denounced—given by several Arab intellectuals to denial theory. According to this perspective, "The Zionist crimes appear far worse than 'exaggerated' Nazi crimes."[1]

The word Holocaust itself has also become a means for various ideologically or politically motivated movements to metaphorically compare phenomena they oppose with the mass extermination of Jews in World War II. This is the case, for instance, with notions such as the "abortion Holocaust" or the "animal Holocaust." These abuses can serve as prisms on the manipulative nature of these movements.[2]

The history of the Second World War offers a prime example of how Jews can serve as a prism to understand complex issues. The war was a period of unlimited atrocities, the Holocaust being the pinnacle of German evil. By analyzing German crimes one can also see how the ideology of political antisemitism and National Socialism turned the mass murder of the Jews into a unique industrial operation. Its major elements included registration, systematic discrimination, transportation to extermination camps, forced labor until exhaustion and death or murder. We can also analyze the behavior of the Allied leadership, who represented the democratic alternative to Nazi totalitarianism. The leaders of the free world refused to bomb Auschwitz or rescue European Jews, even though they knew in detail what was happening from various sources.

The Post-Holocaust Period as a Prism

One can use the post-Holocaust period as a prism to analyze the behavior of many countries on a variety of issues. Norway, for instance, before 1939 was a country with a miniscule Jewish population of about 2,000. Nevertheless, the wartime pro-Nazi government headed by Vidkun Quisling arrested the country's Jews, and stole their belongings, all without German assistance. Thereafter the Norwegian government handed the arrested Jews over to the Germans so that they could be sent to Auschwitz.

For years after the war, democratic governments and authorities in Norway continued to steal money from the expropriated accounts of murdered Norwegian Jews. It took half a century before this ugly story became public knowledge and eventually, some belated remedial action was taken.[3]

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